











The **Vibes** Will Run Out

“Taste” as the New Organizational Operating System

Tezan Sahu

Applied Scientist 2

Microsoft

A Little About Me...

- **Microsoft IDC (2021 – Present)**
 - **Applied Scientist II (2025 – Present)** *[M365 Copilot Extensibility]*
 - **Software Engineer II (2024 – 2025)** *[M365 Copilot Extensibility]*
 - **Data & Applied Scientist II (2023 - 2024)** *[Bing Autosuggest + Search History]*
 - **Data & Applied Scientist (2021 - 2023)** *[Bing Autosuggest]*
- **Visiting Faculty** at Bower School of Entrepreneurship
- **IIT Bombay (2017 – 21)**
 - Major in Mech. Engg (9.90 CPI) | Minor in CSE
 - **Institute Rank 2** | Department Rank 1
- **Author of “Beyond Code” – a National Bestseller**
- **Author of “Low-Pass Filter” – AI Newsletter**
- **7 US Patents | 2 Research Papers**
- Empowered 20,000+ students & professionals in AI & Data Science



01

The God Mode Illusion

The Barriers Have Collapsed

\$0 → \$20M

ARR in 60 days



Lovable

1M+

websites generated



Bolt

2M+

paying users

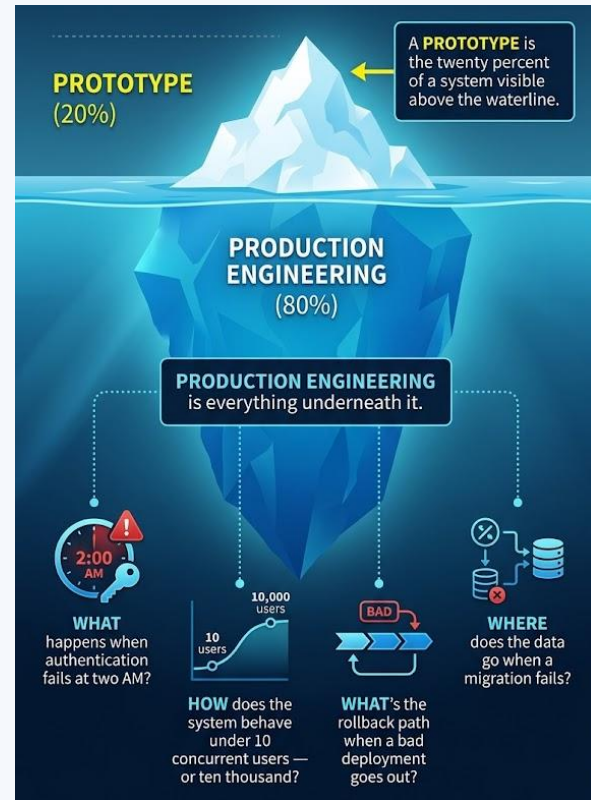
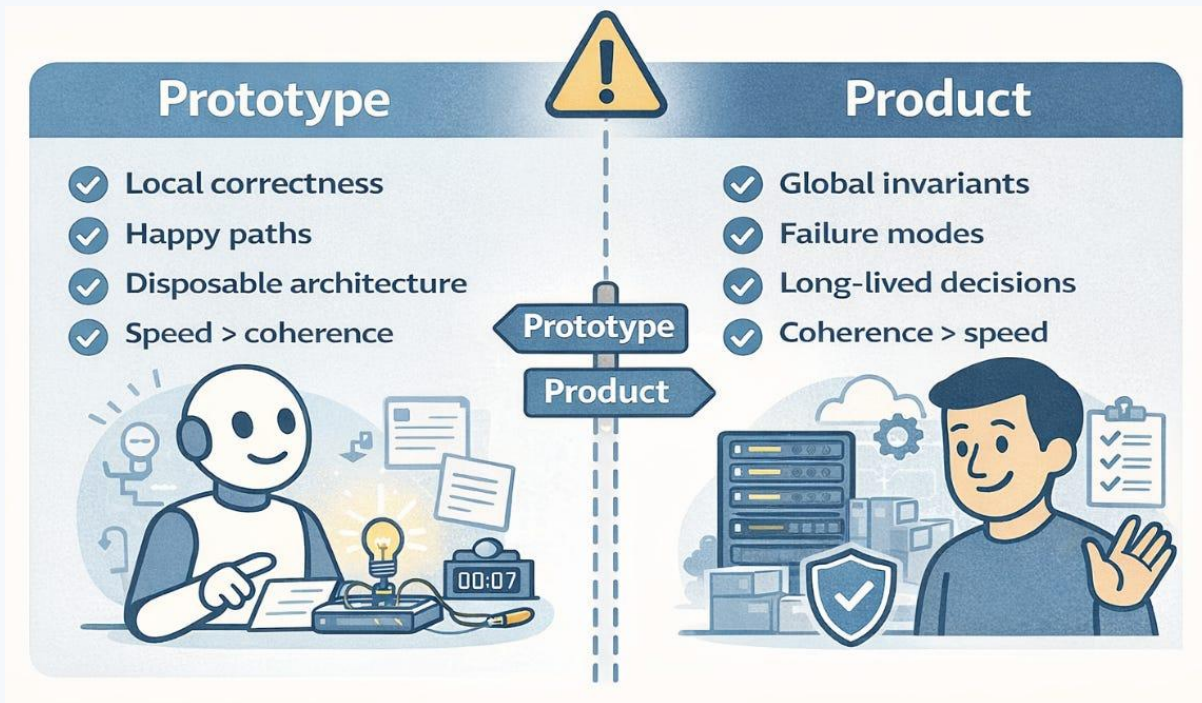


GitHub Copilot

Who's *actually* using these?

- Non-technical founders validating ideas
- Sales teams building custom demos
- Product managers creating hi-fi prototypes
- Marketing teams spinning up dashboards

The Prototype-Product Boundary



The Evidence



1.7x more major issues in AI-co-authored code

- 2.74x higher security vulnerability rates
- 75% more misconfigurations

CodeRabbit analysis of 470 open-source PRs, Dec 2025



Devs using AI were 19% slower on real tasks

...yet believed they were 20% faster

METR randomized controlled trial, Jul 2025

02

Four Things Happening At Once

The Invisible Standard



Code produced without an internalized standard to evaluate it fails in ways that are invisible — until they aren't.



The standard that would catch those problems exists in the profession's institutional memory — not in the tool.

The Ownership Gap

The 3-Month Black Box Effect

- Projects become unmanageable months after launch
- No human ever built a mental model of what was built
- You can't debug what you can't explain
- You can't scale what you can't reason about

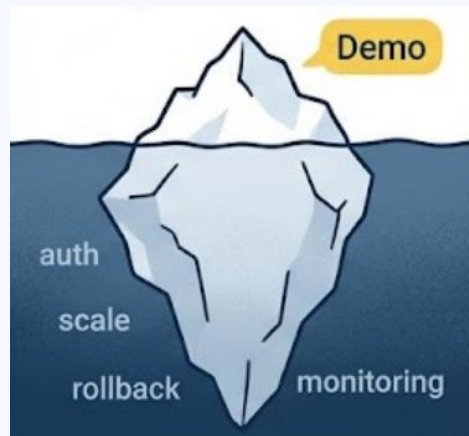
The Expectation Asymmetry

The prototype took a weekend.

The engineering team says weeks to make it production-ready.

Neither side is wrong.

They're looking at different parts of the iceberg.



The Tool Proliferation Trap

Every team is building internal AI tools.

The instinct is: *let them.*

But tools built in separate corners of an organization never encounter each other.



03

This Has Happened Before

Access Always Outpaces Mastery

1985

Desktop Publishing

Anyone with a Mac could typeset.
What followed: the “ransom note era” — every font used, architecturally incoherent.

The tool transferred capability, not the standard.

2009

Aviation Automation

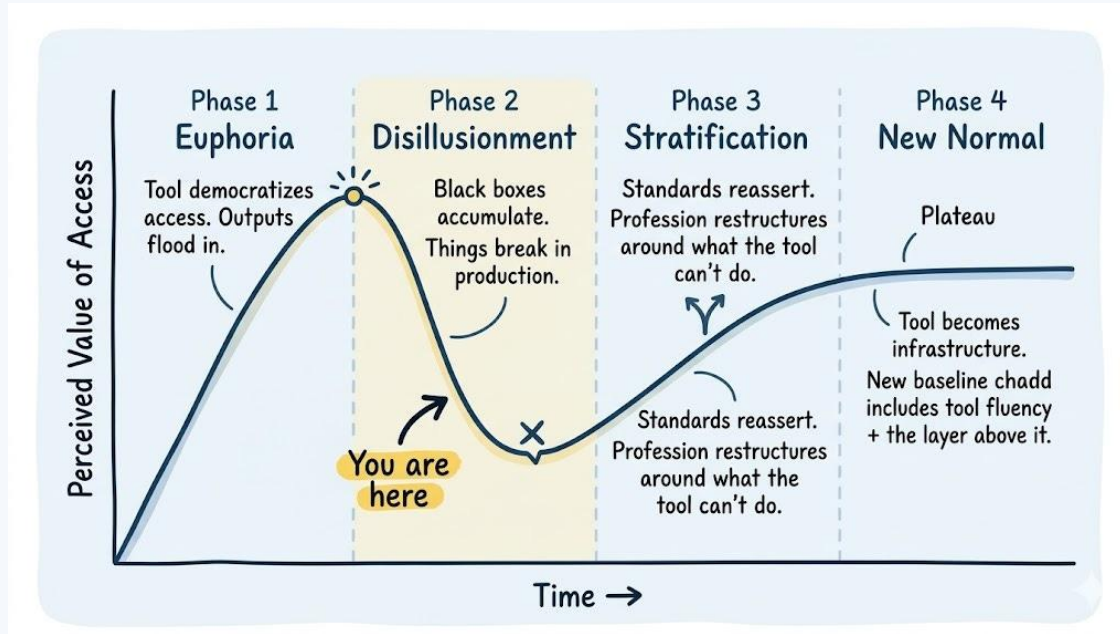
Pilots relied on autopilot without building manual recovery instinct.
AF447: autopilot failed → stall → ocean in 4 minutes.

Capability was accessible. Mastery wasn't built.



Two domains. Same structure. Access always outpaces mastery.

The Shape of Every Democratization Wave



We are deep in Phase 2. **Phase 3 is forming now.**

04

The Commoditization Shift

When Capability Becomes Abundant, Value Migrates Up

→ Electricity became cheap

Value → designing what you build with it

→ Storage became cheap

Value → reasoning about data

→ Bandwidth became cheap

Value → content and experience

Code generation is next in this sequence.

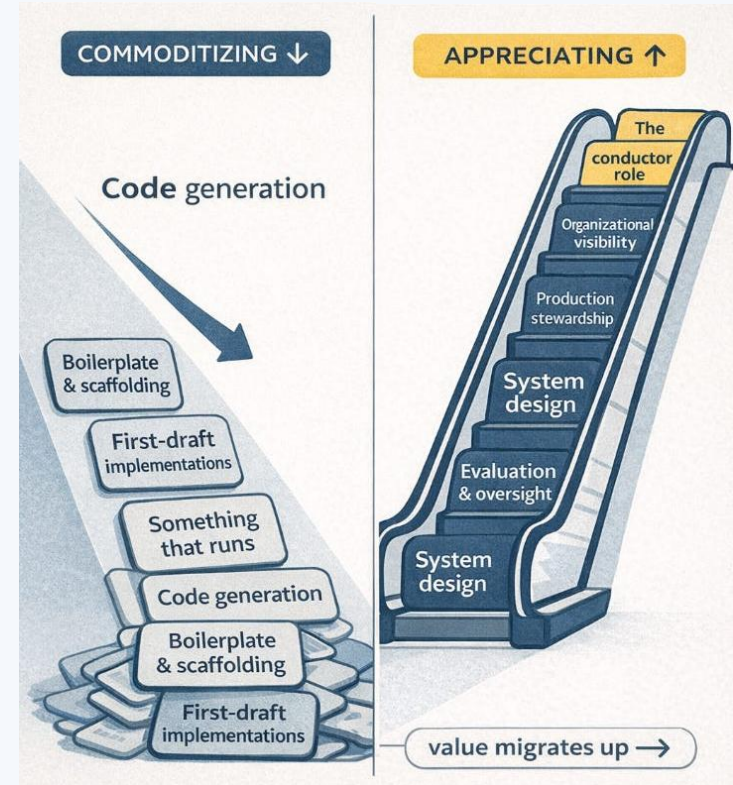
Where Is Value Moving?

Commoditizing...

- Code generation
- Boilerplate and scaffolding
- First-draft implementations
- The ability to produce *“something that runs”*

Appreciating...

- Evaluation and oversight
- System design
- Production stewardship
- Organizational visibility



05

Taste as an Operating System



TASTE

Trained judgment about what will work in the messy real world — not just in demos.



Knowing when to stop — AI generates endlessly; "done" is judgment



Knowing what NOT to build — the best code is code you never write



Knowing which decisions will age well — not today, but in 6 months

Taste Distillation: Tribal Knowledge to Codified Blueprints



Mine your best work

Architecture decisions that held, specs that prevented failures, designs that scaled without rewrites.



Extract taste blueprints

Codify patterns into concrete decision rules — not vague principles, specific guidance.



Inject before generation

Feed blueprints upstream of AI generation.
Front-load the judgment that would otherwise be missing.

The Taste Loop: Verify, Refine, Evolve



Self-Verification

Every AI output checked against the taste blueprint before shipping.
The blueprint is your evaluation rubric.



Expert Refinement

Senior practitioners curate and update blueprints.
Their judgment compounds into the system, not just their heads.



Continuous Evolution

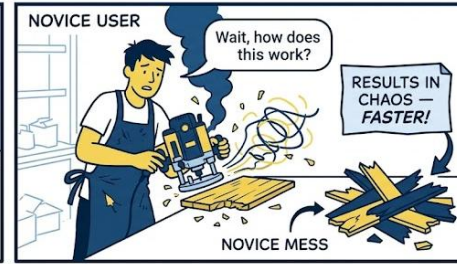
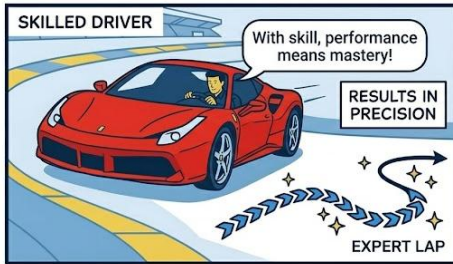
Every post-mortem, incident, and successful launch feeds back.
Living standards, not static documents.

Taste stops being a **personal attribute** → It becomes an **organizational capability**.

The Great Equalizer?

AI rewards people with strong fundamentals far more than beginners.

The “*great equalizer*” actually widens the gap.



06

The Conductor Role

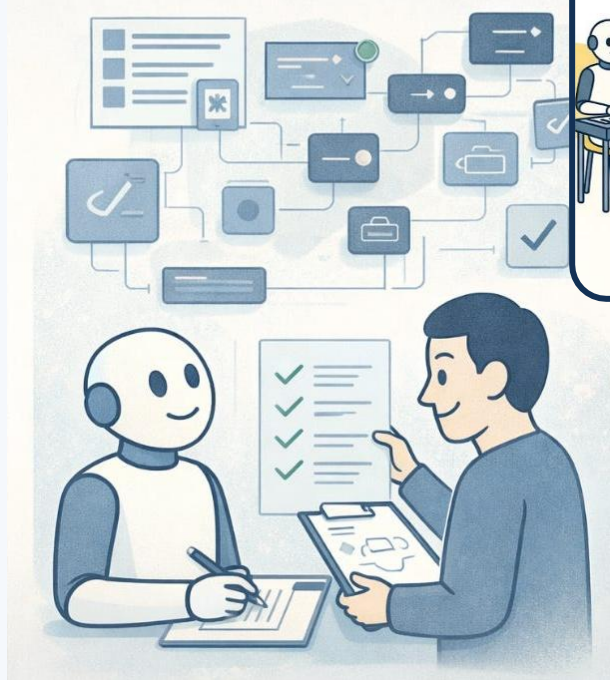
The Profession Is Already Splitting

Vibe Coding



PASSENGER

Taste-Driven Development



CONDUCTOR

Where to Be Standing

“ The designers who survived desktop publishing didn't master PageMaker. They became art directors — occupying the layer of judgment above the tool.

1 Audit the gap

Where are people producing AI output without the standard to evaluate it?

2 Invest in taste

Spec culture, post-project autopsies, architectural review. Competitive infrastructure.

3 Build the conductor layer

Identify who can own, explain, and govern AI-generated systems. Your highest-appreciating asset.



The vibes will always run out.

What remains is the judgment you built along the way.

1

Access is not mastery.

2

The bottleneck has shifted from speed to judgment.

3

Value is migrating to the layer above the tool.

4

The window for positioning deliberately is now.

That's All Folks!

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